There was one prominent example of a young woman in a private university in Lahore who discussed being active on Facebook:

Q.: Are you politically active on social media, Facebook?

Not anymore. We got banned from the NATO page (two girls). So on the NATO page they were saying how successful they were in Afghanistan. First my brother just posted a comment, saying we do not like your presence here, and the admin kept deleting his comment. We actually wrote and included textual evidence related to the problems of their operation, we did our research and gave them proper evidence but they also kept deleting us, and then they blocked us from their page. This was also during the time when NATO forces were passing through the Pakistani border, during Gilani's period.

Q.: Why did you stop being politically active?

No point. We might just end up like Sabeen.

(Focus Group, Private University[15])

The problem of Facebook as a potential 'echo chamber' is clearly evident in this example where the administrator of the NATO page kept deleting the comments posted by these young people, instead of engaging in a debate with them. This further raises the question of who decides what is offensive or threatening in a space such as Facebook. While the laws of a country are taken into consideration in banning Facebook pages or individuals as evident in the preceding discussion, administrators of specific pages also have the space to block or delete comments. Individuals have the ability to block or delete 'friends', especially in instances where they might be offended by their friends' comments. The level of supposed engagement between individuals with diverse viewpoints is therefore suspect. What is also more alarming in this participant narrative is the fear that this young woman and her brother describe of ending 'up like Sabeen'; the participant is referring to Sabeen Mahmood's murder as discussed earlier in the book (see Ali and Zaman 2016).

The extent to which social media provides a forum where one is preaching to the choir (the 'echo chamber') or engaging in a debate ('trench warfare') depends on the individual. Whether such engagement will result in action offline again may vary among individuals. But the extreme efforts taken by the state to crack down on any form of online activity, and the real-world consequences of posting opinions online that have led to lynching and death sentences, reveal that even online activism in Pakistan is both under threat and poses a threat to the State. The national narrative of Pakistan cannot be challenged, even by a minority, even by those whose only point of action is a 'status update' on Facebook or